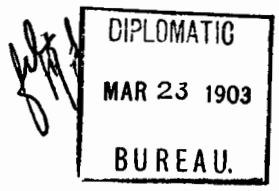
~2



No.529

EMBASSY OF THE UNITED STATES.

St.Petersburg,February 12,1902.



FOR RELS. 1902.

Mr.Tower

To the Honorable John Hay,

Secretary of State.

Subject:- Transmits herewith a copy of a Note from Count Lamsdorff, dated February 9th, and confirms his cipher telegram of the 10th of February, a translation of which is herewith attached. Both relating to Manchuria.



No. 529

EMBASSY OF THE UNITED STATES.

St.Petersburg,February 12,1902.

To the Honorable

John Hay,

Secretary of State,

Washington,D.C.

Sir:-

I have the honor to enclose to you herewith a copy of the reply of Count Lamsdorff, Imperial Minister for Foreign Affairs, dated the 9th of February, to the Note which I addressed to him, under telegraphic instructions from you, on the 3rd of February, in regard to the report that exclusive concessions in Manchuria were about to be granted by China to the Russo-Chinese Bank.

As this reply is of so great moment and as the inquiry made by you has elicited the very important declaration, in writing, that Russia firmly intends to withdraw her troops from Manshuria and return that province to China,as soon as arrangements for the evacuation can be made and precautions taken to guard against a fresh outbreak, I telegraphed it to you in very full detail in my cipher despatch of the 10th of February,a copy of the text of which is respectfully attached hereto.

In order that the Count Lamsdorff's Note may be brought as fully as possible before you, I enclose herewith copies of the original Russian text, of the French translation of it which accompanied it from the Imperial Ministry for Foreign Affairs and of an English translation made at this Embassy.

I have the honor to be, Sir,

Your obedient servant,

Charlemagne Tower,

Copy.

Министерство Иностранных Дѣлъ.
Первый Департаментъ
Январь 27 дня 1902 года.
№ 96.

Господинъ Посолъ,

Императорское Правительство, въ постоянномъ стремленіи своемъ поддерживать и развивать наилучшія отношенія съ Сѣверо-Американскими Соединенными Штатами, вполнѣ готово устранить опасенія, внушаемыя, повидимому, Вашингтонскому Кабинету предположенными соглашеніями между Россіею и Китаемъ, но вмѣстѣ съ тѣмъ Императорское Правительство считаетъ долгомъ заявить, что переговоры между двумя совершенно независимыми Государствами не могутъ подлежать контролю другихъ Державъ.

Ни о какомъ нарушеніи принципа "открытыхъ дверей", какъ его понимаетъ Императорское Правительство, нѣтъ и рѣчи, и Россія ни въ чемъ не намѣрена видоизмѣнять политики, коей она слѣдовала по этому вопросу до сего времени.

Если бы Русско-Китайскій банкъ получилъ въ Китаѣ какія либо концессіи, то соотвѣтственные контракты частнаго свойства

не въ коемъ не отличались бы отъ тѣхъ, кои были ранѣе того заключены столькими иностранными Компаніями.

Не представляемся ли бы затѣмъ весьма страннымъ, чтобы "открытыя двери" для нѣкоторыхъ Державъ были закрыты для Россіи, которая граничитъ съ Маньчжуріею и которая была вынуждена послѣдними событіями послать войска въ эту область въ видахъ возстановленія порядка въ общихъ и несомнѣнныхъ интересахъ всѣхъ Державъ. Въ сущности Россія завоевала Маньчжурію, но тѣмъ не менѣе она сохраняетъ твердое намѣреніе возвратить эту область Китаю и отозвать свои войска, какъ только будутъ установлены условія эвакуаціи и приняты необходимыя мѣры для предупрежденія новыхъ безпорядковъ въ этихъ пограничныхъ мѣстностяхъ.

Невозможно оспаривать у независимаго государства право выдачи другимъ концессій, коими оно свободно располагаетъ, и я имѣю полное основаніе думать, что требованія Русско-Китайскаго Банка не въ коемъ не превышаютъ тѣхъ, кои такъ часто предъявляются другими иностранными Компаніями. Въ виду сего я полагаю, что Императорскому Правительству трудно было бы оказывать русскимъ Компаніямъ меньшую поддержку, чѣмъ та, которая оказывается другими Правительствами компаніямъ и синдикатамъ ихъ національности.

Во всякомъ случаѣ я прошу Ваше Превосходительство быть увѣреннымъ въ томъ, что никто и не можетъ быть рѣчи о какомъ либо "отступленіи" отъ тѣхъ завѣреній, которыя я имѣлъ случай высказывать относительно принциповъ, коими, по указаніямъ Государя Императора, неизмѣнно руководствуется русская политика.

Примите, Господинъ Посолъ, увѣреніе въ отличномъ моемъ почтеніи.

(signed) Граферъ Ламздорфъ.

Его Прев-ву Сэру Шарлеманю Тоузу
Послу Сѣверо-Американскихъ Соединенныхъ
Штатовъ, &c. &c.

COPIE D'UNE TRADUCTION.

MINISTERE DES AFFAIRES ETRANGERES.

Premier Département.

N°.96.- le 27 Janvier (9 Février),1902.

Monsieur l'Ambassadeur,

Le Gouvernement IMPÉRIAL, toujours désireux de cultiver et de développer les meilleures relations avec les Etats-Unis d'Amérique, est tout diaposé à éloigner les inquiétudes que semblent inepirer au Cahinet de Washington les arrangements projetés entre la Russie et la Chine, mais en même temps il croit devoir constater que les négociations entre deux Etats parfaitement indépendants ne sauraient être subordonnées au contrôle d'autres Puissances.

Il ne s'agit d'aucune atteinte au principe de la "Porte ouverte" tel qu'il est entendu par le Gouvernement IMPÉRIAL de Russie, qui compte ne modifier en rien la politique suivie jusqu'à présent à cet égard.

Si la Banque Russo-Chinoise obtenait des concessions en Chine, les contrats de nature privée qui s'y rapporteraient ne différeraient pas de ceux conclus antérieurement par tant d'autres compagnies étrangères. Ne serait-il pas d'ailleurs fort surprenant que la "porte-ouverte" à certains Etats soit fermée à la Russie qui est limitrophe de la Mandjourie, et que les derniers évènements ont obligée à envoyer des troupes dans cette province en vue du rétablissement de l'ordre dans un intérêt commun et évident de toutes les Puissances. De fait la Russie a conquis la Mandjourie, mais elle a maintenu nonobstant la ferme intention de la restituer à la Chine et de rappeler ses troupes aussitôt que les conditions de l'évacuation auront été réglées et que les mesures nécessaires pour prévenir

de nouveaux troubles dans ces régions avoisinantes auront été prises.

Il est impossible de contester à un pays indépendant le droit d'accorder à d'autres des concessions dont il est libre de disposer et j'ai tout lieu de croire que les demandes de la Banque Russo-Chinoise ne dépassent en rien les exigences formulées si fréquemment par d'autres compagnies étrangères, et je pense dès lors qu'il serait difficile au Gouvernement IMPÉRIAL d'appuyer moins les compagnies russes que ne le font d'autres Gouvernements à l'égard de compagnies et de syndicats de leur nationalité.

En tout cas je prie Votre Excellence d'être persuadée qu'il n'est et ne peut être question d'aucune "dénégation" des assurances que j'ai été dans le cas de donner relativement aux principes qui, d'ordre de SA MAJESTÉ l'EMPEREUR, guident invariablement la politique Russe.

Veuillez agréer, Monsieur l'Ambassadeur, l'assurance de ma haute considération.

(signé) Comte Lamsdorff.

a S.E.Charlemagne Tower

Ambassadeur des Etats-Unis & &

TRANSLATION.

MINISTRY FOR FOREIGN AFFAIRS.

First Department.

January 27(February 9),1902. N°.96

Mr.Ambassador:-

The Imperial Government, always desirous of cultivating and developing the best relations with the United States of America, is fully disposed to remove the anxiety which the proposed arrangements between Russia and China appear to have caused the Cabinet at Washington; but it feels itself bound at the same time to declare that negotiations carried on between two entirely independent States are not subjects to be submitted to the approval of other Powers.

There is no thought of attacking the principle of the "Open Door" as that principle is understood by the Imperial Government of Russia, and Russia has no intention whatever to change the policy followed by her in that respect up to the present time.

If the Russo-Chinese Bank should obtain concessions in China the agreements of a private character relating to them would not differ from those heretofore concluded by so many other foreign corporations. But would it not be very strange if the "Door" that is "Open" to certain nations should be closed to Russia whose frontier adjoins that of Manchuria and who has been forced by recent events to send her troops into that province to re-establish order in the plain and common interest of all nations! It is true that Russia has conquered Manchuria, but she still maintains her firm determination to restore it to China and recall her troops as soon as the conditions of evacuation shall have been agreed upon and the necessary steps taken to prevent a fresh outbreak of troubles in the neigh-

boring territory.

It is impossible to deny to an independent State the right to grant to others such concessions as it is free to dispose of, and I have every reason to believe that the demands of the Russo-Chinese Bank do not in the least exceed those that have been so often formulated by other foreign companies, and I feel that under the circumstances it would not be easy for the Imperial Government to deny to Russian companies that support which is given by other Governments to companies and syndicates of their own nationalities.

At all events, I beg Your Excellency to believe that there is not, nor can there be, any question of the contradiction of the assurances which, under the orders of His Majesty the Emperor, I have had occasion to give heretofore in regard to the principles which invariably direct the policy of Russia.

Please accept, Mr.Ambassador, the assurance of my high consideration.

(signed) Count Lamsdorff.

To His Excellency

Charlemagne Tower,

Ambassador of the United States ,

etc., etc., etc.,

Translation of a cipher telegram sent

February 10,1902.

EMBASSY OF THE UNITED STATES.

St.Petersburg,February 10,1902.

"SECSTATE, - WASHINGTON.

"The answer of the Russian Minister for Foreign Affairs in regard to Manchuria says the Russian Government always desires to cultivate and extend the best relations with the United States and is willing now to remove the anxiety at Washington caused by proposed arrangements in China.But it feels bound at the same time to declare that negotiations between two independent States are not subject to the approval of other States. No attack has been made upon the Open Door as that principle is understood by Russia and Russia does not intend to change the policy pursued by her heretofore."

"Any concessions granted to the Russian Chinese Bank would be of the same character as those already granted under private agreement to many other foreign corporations and it would be strange if the door that is open to other nations should be closed to Russia whose frontier adjoins Manchuria. Russia has sent her troops into Manchuria to establish order in the interest of all nations. Russia has conquered Manchuria but still maintains her firm determination to restore it to China and withdraw her troops as soon as the conditions of evacuation are settled and precautions taken against a recurrence of the difficulty. Nobody can deny to an independent State the right to grant such concessions as it is free to dispose of".

"The Minister for Foreign Affairs has reason to believe that the demands of the Russian Chinese Bank do not exceed those frequently made by other foreign corporations

and Russia cannot refuse to Russian Companies the protection given by other States to syndicates and corporations of their own nationality".

"The Minister for Foreign Affairs closes with the declaration that there is no intention on the side of Russia to depart from the assurances heretofore given as to the principles which invariably direct her policy".

TOWER.